PROTOTYPE SNAPSHOT · 13 NOVEMBER 2026

DecisionTrail

Municipal Readiness Report

CIVIC Hack 2026 / Team: DecisionTrail

01 THE PROBLEM

Residents can mistake a procedural vote, referral or request for a report for a decision to deliver a service. Municipal records distinguish these actions, but interpreting them requires following different bodies, motions and dates. We focus on explaining what an individual record actually establishes.

02 YOUR SOLUTION

DecisionTrail is a working, static web prototype for residents. Choose one of three archived Toronto examples, compare what the action establishes with what it does not, follow the recorded decision path, and open the official record and find the named section. Future participation information stays explicitly unverified rather than becoming an invented deadline.

03 WHAT CHANGES

The prototype brings action, authority and evidential limits together. It aims to reduce mistaken conclusions about approval or completion; improved resident comprehension has not yet been measured.

04 DATA SOURCES AND TOOLS

Original factual summaries link to Toronto items 2026.MM43.16, 2026.TE34.98 and 2026.IE31.8, plus City participation guidance, checked November 13. No City documents or personal correspondence are bundled; no blanket open-data licence is claimed. Tools: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Node.js 24, GitHub Pages, OpenAI assistant for code/text/tests, and Python 3.12/ReportLab for this PDF. No runtime model or API calls.

05 WHAT COULD BE PILOTED TODAY

A facilitated pilot can use three real archival cases; no live feed is simulated. Desktop baseline checks and 18 source tests pass. Before broader use, test comprehension, narrow screens, reduced motion and assistive technology, and verify later proceedings.

06 ADOPTING OR SCALING IT

A municipal clerk or designated reviewer should own each explanation, its source links and refresh date. Map each municipality's actual decision authority and provincial participation rules; do not impose a universal committee-to-council sequence. Add cases only after factual and rights review, with corrections and stale-record warnings. Current hosting is free and there are no paid APIs; staff curation, accessibility testing and support are real costs, not estimated savings. The prototype collects no resident input or analytics and links to official channels instead. Hosting providers still receive normal web requests. Keep public comments and personal correspondence out of the dataset.

EXPLORE / VERIFY Prototype Source MM43.16 TE34.98 IE31.8

Archival snapshot, not a live hearing finder or legal advice.